

Ella Iles

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EDUCATION

- Harvard University** 2026 - Present
Ph.D. Astronomy at the Center for Astrophysics Harvard and Smithsonian.
- McGill University** 2021-2025
B.Sc. Honours Physics,
Honours Thesis: Dark Photon and Axion Production in Magnetized White Dwarfs,
Supervisor: Katelin Schutz. First Class Honours, CGPA: 3.99/4.00, Dean's Honour List.
- Berlin British School** 2019-2021
International Baccalaureate Diploma,
Score: 44/45 (top 0.7% worldwide).

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Ashburn Fellowship, Harvard University** 2026
Fellows comprise a community of students who produce scholarship in, and creative solutions for, some of today's most fascinating questions across the sciences and the humanities. With a cohort of five students selected each year, the Ashford Fellowship provides generous support for multiple years of study. USD \$8000 per anum.
- P.R. Wallace Prize in Physics, McGill University** 2025
Awarded by the Faculty of Science Scholarships Committee on recommendation of the Department of Physics to a graduating student who has shown marked aptitude for studies in theoretical physics. CA \$525.
- Dean's Honour List, McGill University** 2022-2025
CGPA in the top 10% of the Faculty of Science.
- James F. Mathison Scholarship, McGill University** 2024-2025
Scholarship awarded on the basis of distinguished academic standing to a student enrolled in the Honours Physics program. CA \$3,100.
- Best Presentation Award, Trottier Space Institute** 2024
Top prize awarded at the Trottier Space Institute Summer Undergraduate Research Showcase. CA \$125.
- Undergraduate Summer Research Award (USRA), NSERC** 2024
Funded by the Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC), CA \$8,700.
- Undergraduate Research Supplement, FRQ** 2024
Funded by the Fonds de recherche du Québec (FRQ). CA \$1,500.
- Tomlinson Engagement Award for Mentoring, McGill University** 2023, 2025
Mentoring Award given on the basis of excellence in teaching, learning and mentorship. CA \$350 $\times$ 2.
- Garnet and Jane Shaver Veteran's Scholarship, McGill University** 2023-2024
Awarded to an outstanding undergraduate student on the basis of high academic standing by the Faculty of Science Scholarships Committee. CA \$3,250.
- J.W. McConnell Scholarship, McGill University** 2021-2025
Renewable scholarship awarded based on exceptional academic and extracurricular achievements. CA \$20,000 total.

PUBLICATIONS

- D. Sarkar, **E. Iles**, A. Liu, "Clues from $\mathcal{Q}$: A Null Test for Line Intensity Mapping Cross-Correlations," submitted to Phys. Rev. D. arXiv:2512.09984.
- N. Brahma, **E. Iles**, H. Scherer, K. Schutz, "Resonant Axion and Dark Photon Production in Magnetic White Dwarfs," 2026, Phys. Rev. D. 113, 083010.
- E. Iles**, S. Heeba, K. Schutz, "Dark Matter Direct Detection Experiments Are Sensitive to the Millicharged Background," 2025, Phys. Rev. Lett. 134, 121002.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	McGill University Dark Matter Group 2024–2025 Honours Thesis Supervisor: Katelin Schutz. Investigated detection potential of millicharged particle backgrounds; published in Phys. Rev. Lett. 134, 121002 (2025) arXiv:2407.21096. Calculated dark photon and axion production in magnetized white dwarfs; submitted to Phys. Rev. D arXiv:2509.07085.
	McGill University Cosmic Dawn Group 2023–2025 Supervisor: Adrian Liu. Investigated the noise properties of novel statistical estimators combining cosmological surveys conducted from four different spectral lines; submitted to Phys. Rev. D. arXiv:2512.09984 Currently collaborating with Dr. Stuart Wyithe’s group at the Australian National University developing a public Python package to supersize simulations of the 21 cm field using effective field theory.
	Advanced Laser Light Source Laboratory Feb–Mar 2023 Institut National de la Recherche Scientifique (INRS). Aligned a 200 TW laser and contributed to building a new beamline extension to achieve world-leading intensities.
	International Physics Tournament 2022–2023 Team Canada Member for McGill University. Investigated plasma creation from graphite in a microwave, the “infinite lamp,” and the “singing ice” phenomenon.
TEACHING AND MENTORING	Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, McGill University 2023, 2025 PHYS 102 (Introduction to Electromagnetism) and PHYS 351 (Honours Classical Mechanics II). Held weekly tutorials and office hours.
	Private Tutor 2021–Present Tutored International Baccalaureate and Advanced Placement students in mathematics, physics and chemistry; supported McGill students in Math 133 (Linear Algebra).
LEADERSHIP	Undergraduate Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Coordinator 2024–2025 McGill Physics Department. Organized EDI initiatives and resource accessibility projects with the McGill Society of Physics Students (MSPS).
	Wilderness Canoe Trip Guide, Camp Wanapitei 2022–2025 Guiding youth on canoe trips in Northern Ontario and Quebec. Teaching outdoors skills, environmental stewardship and indigenous history.
	Whitewater Executive, McGill Outdoors Club 2023–2025 Led kayaking trips and safety sessions on the Rouge and St. Lawrence Rivers; ran weekly “Learn to Roll” sessions at McGill pool.
	Head Girl, Berlin British School 2021 Recognized for academic excellence and leadership.
TALKS	
	Friday Lunch Talks, Australian National University October 2025 Introduction to using stars to look for beyond the standard model particles with light boson production in white dwarfs as a case study.
	End of Summer Research Showcase, Trottier Space Institute August 2024 On millicharged particle production in the early universe and the possibility of detecting them using dark matter detection experiments.

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE	Wilderness Canoe Trip Guide, Camp Wanapitei June 2022–Present Guided youth on 6–30 day wilderness canoe expeditions in Northern Ontario and Quebec. Responsible for safety, logistics, route planning, and group dynamics. Selected for strong leadership, collaboration, and risk-management skills.
	Editor for The Abstract, McGill Science Undergraduate Research Journal 2022–2023 Editor for the popular science blog The Abstract run by The McGill Undergraduate Research Journal.
	Reforestation Worker, Folklore Contracting / Blue Collar Silviculture 2022–2023 Worked in British Columbia (Prince George, Fort St. James, Quesnel) planting up to 3,500 trees per day in remote and physically demanding conditions over two summers.
	Antique Jewelry Sales 2017 Sold pieces of antique jewelry at flea markets in Ottawa. The collection had an emphasis on brutalist design.
TECHNICAL SKILLS	Programming: Python (NumPy, SciPy, Matplotlib), Mathematica, Java, LaTeX. Research: Numerical simulation, data analysis, model development. Languages: English (native), French (B2).
CERTIFICATIONS	National Lifeguard (NLS) Certified lifeguard qualified in pool and open water rescue, first aid, and emergency response.
	Wilderness First Responder (WFR) Certified to handle medical emergencies in remote environments. Highest level of wilderness first aid without EMT training.
	Whitewater Rescue Technician (WRT I–III) Certified to perform whitewater rescues and guide whitewater canoe and kayak trips safely. Highest level of whitewater rescue certification.
INTERESTS	Canoe Tripping: Longest trip was a 54-day self-sustained expedition from the Yukon into the Northwest Territories. Whitewater Kayaking: Paddling on the Ottawa and Gatineau Rivers. Reading Literature